Alejandra Tamez de la Garza

Generative AI Transformation Leader | Executive Workshops, Keynotes, and Coaching

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SUMMARY

Generative AI transformation leader who scaled enablement to **13,000+ employees across 12+ geographies**, spanning Microsoft Copilot, Claude, GitHub, and Cursor. Led **80+ generative AI workshops**, built a **200 person Champions Network**, and ran C suite sessions where executives built 30/60/90 day plans and their own agents. **Keynote speaker, Forrester IT conference 2026.**

Combines Prosci certified change management with hands on building. Every engagement ends with a tailored roadmap, a named owner, and one measurable experiment. Creator of the Enablement Flywheel and the AI Use Case Prioritization Framework. Previously led Amazon's SNAP pilot from launch to all 50 states.

CORE SKILLS

Generative AI Transformation Strategy | Executive Advisory and Workshops | Organizational Change Management (Prosci) | Process Redesign | Value Realization | Keynote and Executive Presentations | Customer Engagement | Team Leadership and Coaching | AI Governance | Rapid Prototyping with Generative AI | Agents and AI Chief of Staff Design | Champions Networks | Bilingual Facilitation (English and Spanish)

HOW I WORK

- **Listen first.** Start with the real challenge in the room and the habits that make a new idea hard to try.
- **Start with value.** Lead with what generative AI could change about someone's workday or business, then the features.
- **Turn ambition into a small, credible test.** Leaders leave with one experiment, a named owner, and a clear way to judge the result.
- **Build alongside leaders.** Lasting transformation needs people free to explore and leaders willing to learn with them.
- **Share the hard lessons.** Teach what failed as openly as what worked.

EXPERIENCE

Generative AI Enablement Lead and Change Management Lead

Applied Materials | Austin, Texas | 2022 to Present

When Copilot and Claude licenses arrived without a change plan, onboarding, or training, I built the human system around the technology, growing enablement to 13,000+ employees across 12+ geographies.

- **Executive workshops:** Led sessions where C suite leaders built 30/60/90 day plans for strategic alignment on what their business needs to grow 10x, and created their own AI projects and declarative agents from a real need.
- **Change workshops:** Brought the people who do the work together to redesign a process. Teams wrote the instructions, knowledge, and project files to build their own AI chief of staff or tracking dashboard, then agreed on who would test it.
- **AI chief of staff for a senior partner:** Guided a leader supporting 8+ C suite executives to design and build an agent that answers their questions far faster.
- **From one survey to a movement:** Offered training to any team that asked, and delivered 80+ lunch and learns within a year, each shaped around the team in the room.
- **Skeptic to sponsor:** A leader convinced AI would make her work sloppier built her own AI project two weeks later, then asked me to train her whole team.
- **Coaching people to lead:** Built a 200 person Champions Network and coached Champions to run sessions of their own.
- **Product feedback:** Meet weekly with Microsoft to share concrete user needs and product improvements for Copilot.
- **Governance:** Contribute insights and data analysis to a weekly call with the Chief of AI and senior leaders, improving how the group makes decisions.
- **The hard lesson:** Access is not adoption. Leadership becomes a bottleneck without room to experiment, and everything opens once a leader feels the value firsthand. I rebuilt my framework around that lesson.

Community Engagement Leader, Partnerships and Events

Amazon | 2 years

- **SNAP pilot:** Led the pilot helping EBT cardholders access Amazon grocery benefits, building trust with nonprofits, universities, and churches until it scaled to all 50 states.
- **Team leadership:** Managed direct reports while carrying my own partner work.

Office Manager and Marketing

GiveCampus, Y Combinator backed education technology company | 2 years

- Ran operations and much of the marketing for a fast growing startup.

Executive Assistant to the Founder and CEO

Arabella Advisors

- Supported the founder and CEO of a philanthropic advisory firm, learning how leaders think, decide, and align a company around a mission.

Founder and Operator

Retail business partnering with indigenous women artisans

- Built and run the business end to end, from sourcing and logistics to sales and storytelling.

SPEAKING AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

- **Keynote speaker,** Forrester IT conference, September 2026
- **Speaker,** AITX, Austin's AI community
- **Panelist** alongside the CIO of SailPoint
- **Show and tells** at a weekly Sunday AI builders club in Austin
- **Writer** at alejandratamez.com on generative AI and human change

SIGNATURE FRAMEWORKS

- **The Enablement Flywheel:** Access, Adoption, Proficiency, New Ways of Working, and Business Reengineering.
- **AI Use Case Prioritization Framework:** A weighted scoring system that shows organizations exactly where to start with generative AI, and why.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

- Master of Public Administration, Virginia Commonwealth University
- Bachelor of Arts, Radford University
- Prosci Certified Change Management Practitioner | Geoff Woods AI Accelerator | IBM and Microsoft certifications in AI and technology

BOARD AND COMMUNITY

- **Director of Marketing and Fundraising,** Board of Bags of Grace, a faith based nonprofit in Austin
- Researched Central Texas data center impacts on water, energy, equity, and labor, with formal recommendations to Austin's Technology Commission
- Bible study host, with mission work in Nicaragua and Costa Rica

WHY I DO THIS

As an immigrant, I carry a perspective that keeps me grounded and grateful. I believe every person is magic and does their best work when treated with dignity and pushed in the right direction. Leaders in my corner shaped and sharpened me, and doing that for others is the work I love most. My mother taught me, "El que no vive para servir, no sirve para vivir."